

SALIM SAYE D

Dynamic Retail Operations Leader: Driving Sales Growth, Market Expansion, and Operational Excellence



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A results-driven Retail Operations Professional with 15+ years of rich experience directing multi-unit store operations, P&L management, and strategic market expansion across the GCC and India. Proven expertise navigating diverse retail sectors, ranging from executing high-growth commercial strategies for fast-paced fashion retail across regional GCC stores to spearheading the massive non-pharma and premium skincare portfolio across UAE network. Expert at scaling brand footprints with a track record of driving aggressive store openings, managing high-volume day-to-day operations, and implementing strict financial governance and process compliance. A strategic leader adept at revitalizing underperforming outposts, launching over 45 stores throughout an impactful career, and designing customized training programs to maximize team productivity, profitability, and customer satisfaction metrics.

WORK EXPERIENCE

LIFE Healthcare Group, Dubai - UAE as Manager, Retail Operations since Jan'25

- **Retail Operations & Regional Leadership:** Headed comprehensive day-to-day retail store operations, enforcing strict financial controls, operational efficiency, and standard operating procedure (SOP) compliance across multiple stores formats with a team size of 200+ team members.
- **Category Governance:** Strategically managed AED 130M non-pharma commercial portfolio across the UAE retail stores network, overseeing end-to-end performance for premium, prestige, and masstige skincare brands alongside core healthcare, and wellness categories.
- **UAE-Wide Footprint Expansion:** Led the New Store Opening team (NSO) function across the UAE, overseeing end-to-end launch execution of 30+ stores, including operations, visual merchandising, space planning, training, customer experience, and cross-functional coordination, ensuring seamless openings and accelerated commercial performance.
- **Performance Turnarounds:** Analyzed local market data and store P&L metrics to revitalize underperforming outlets, optimization strategies that significantly drove up profitability and footprint health.
- **Inventory & Supply Chain Control:** Monitored strict shrinkage controls, visual merchandising excellence, lay-outs, and optimized inventory allocation across the network to secure lean operations and eliminate waste.
- **Cross-Functional Coordination:** Acted as the primary operational liaison between brand management, marketing, supply chain, and frontline retail teams to align execution and maximize customer satisfaction metrics.

Annabelle (Rajan Trading LLC), Dubai as Retail Manager Operations GCC | Jan'19 – Apr'24

- **Multi-Unit Operations & P&L Governance:** Held end-to-end operations and P&L performance for a network of 41 fashion retail stores across the UAE, KSA, Kuwait, and Qatar, leading 3 Country Managers, a Regional Trainer, and a workforce of 155+ store team to drive sales growth, operational excellence, and business profitability for 100M AED annual revenue
- **Commercial Turnarounds & Growth:** Delivered 34% overall growth through commercial strategies and expansion while achieving 14% LFL growth metric (2023-2022) through
- **Aggressive Footprint Expansion:** Spearheaded the successful market introduction, site readiness, and operational rollout of 19 new retail stores across the GCC region.
- **Store Revitalization:** Rescued distressed, underperforming outposts by executing deep operational audits, restructuring staff models, and deploying targeted financial turnaround strategies to restore profitability.

CONTACT

- ☎ 00971585921779
- ✉ salimsayed82@gmail.com
- in [LinkedIn](#)
- 📍 Dubai, UAE

SKILLS PORTFOLIO

- Retail Operations
- Store Management
- Operational Efficiency
- Sales Optimization
- Customer Satisfaction
- Profit Maximization
- Inventory Management
- Cost Control
- Performance Tracking
- Market Intelligence
- Competitor Analysis
- Financial Governance
- Resource Management
- Expansion and Brand Management
- Marketing and Advertising
- Brand Support
- Visual Merchandising
- Training and Development
- Process Implementation
- Service Delivery
- Process Compliance
- Quality Assurance
- Performance Monitoring
- Sales Support
- Customer Relations
- Training and Performance Enhancement
- Interdepartmental Coordination
- Strategic Leadership
- Performance Enhancement
- Stakeholder Management
- Cross-functional Coordination

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Commerce | Mumbai University | 2002

CERTIFICATIONS

- Six Sigma – Black Belt
- Operational Excellence Foundations

- **SOP Standardization:** Authored and institutionalized a comprehensive playbook of Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and process guaranteeing operational excellence and brand alignment from store inception onwards.
- **Inventory & Supply Chain Efficiency:** Streamlined end-to-end inventory management and stock allocation across all regions, maximizing display effectiveness, boosting stock availability, and minimizing shrinkage.
- **Talent & Performance Management:** Designed and curated tailored retail training programs specializing in advanced sales techniques, localized business strategy, and leadership development to build high-performing store teams.
- **Marketing & Brand Integration:** Directed regional advertising and promotional campaigns aligned with major brand and mall calendars, optimizing marketing spend with a strict focus on ROI.
- **CSR & Community Engagement:** Partnered and collaborated with the Red Crescent and local community entities to create impactful marketing initiatives that strengthened brand equity and emotional connection.

LIFE Healthcare Group, Dubai – UAE as Area Manager Operations | Oct'16 – Dec'18

- **Multi-Format Territory Leadership:** Commanded comprehensive day-to-day retail store operations across a diverse portfolio of High Street and Mall locations ranging from 500 to 6,500 sq. ft., safeguarding strict brand guidelines and operational alignment.
- **LFL Sales Growth & Turnarounds:** Secured consistent double-digit, like-for-like (LFL) sales growth across multiple locations and successfully transformed underperforming, low-margin storefronts into highly profitable retail units.
- **Footprint Scaling & Launches:** Spearheaded the operational setup, cross-functional recruitment pipelines, and successful market introduction of new store openings within the assigned region.
- **Succession Planning & Talent Pipeline:** Engineered comprehensive succession strategies to train, mentor, and deploy incoming Area Managers, building a culture of exemplary leadership aligned with the brand's ambitious expansion targets.
- **Inventory Control & Shrinkage Mitigation:** Instituted rigorous inventory management and strict expiry tracking protocols to optimize stock allocation across networks, control shrinkage, and minimize category wastage.
- **P&L & Process Optimization:** Implemented strategic cost-reduction measures and streamlined storefront workflows to elevate personnel productivity and peak efficiency across all facets of operations.
- **Customer Experience & Client Retention:** Partnered closely with frontline retail sales and customer relations teams to enforce consumer-centric practices, maximizing service standards and client contentment metrics.

Forest Essentials Luxurious Skincare (Estee Lauder Group), India as Regional Manager Operations Sep'11- Mar'16

- **Revenue Acceleration & Scaling:** Doubled regional retail revenue across assigned territories through data-driven staff placement, strategic local marketing initiatives, and strict inventory controls.
- **Geographic Market Penetration:** Spearheaded the successful end-to-end setup, recruitment, and commercial launch of 12 new luxury retail stores across the West and South regions of India.
- **Rapid Professional Advancement:** Earned 3 consecutive promotions throughout tenure in recognition of high performance, strong operational leadership, and measurable bottom-line contributions.
- **SOP & Process Optimization:** Authored, implemented, and institutionalized store-level Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and corporate sales processes to streamline day-to-day retail operations.
- **Shrinkage & Compliance Control:** Implemented rigorous checks, balances, and auditing metrics to effectively manage shrinkage, preserve stock integrity, and maximize retail profitability.
- **Visual Merchandising Excellence:** Enforced consistent brand guidelines across all regional locations, updating visual merchandising displays to enhance store aesthetics and optimize customer engagement.
- **Product Launch Strategy:** Partnered with product development teams to execute new product introductions, leveraging market research and localized customer feedback to drive retail adoption.
- **Talent Development & Mentorship:** Directed region-wide talent acquisition, onboarding, and comprehensive systems/product training programs, mentoring storefront teams to consistently hit performance goals.

PREVIOUS WORK EXPERIENCE

- Kaizen Global Services India Pvt. Ltd. (BPO), India as Team Leader Operations | Mar'06- Aug'10
- Imercious India Pvt Ltd (BPO), India as Process Executive | May'04- Mar'06
- HDFC Bank, India as Corporate Executive | Aug'02- Apr'04